ERA 20

Black Power & a Movement Divided

1965 – 1968

The northern struggle · Malcolm X · Black Power · 1968

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

Why did the civil rights movement fracture after its greatest victories?

KEY TERMS

De facto segregation · Malcolm X · Black Power · the Black Panthers · King's assassination

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 8.10 · AMSCO Ch. 8.10

BEYOND THE SOUTH

A Movement at a Crossroads

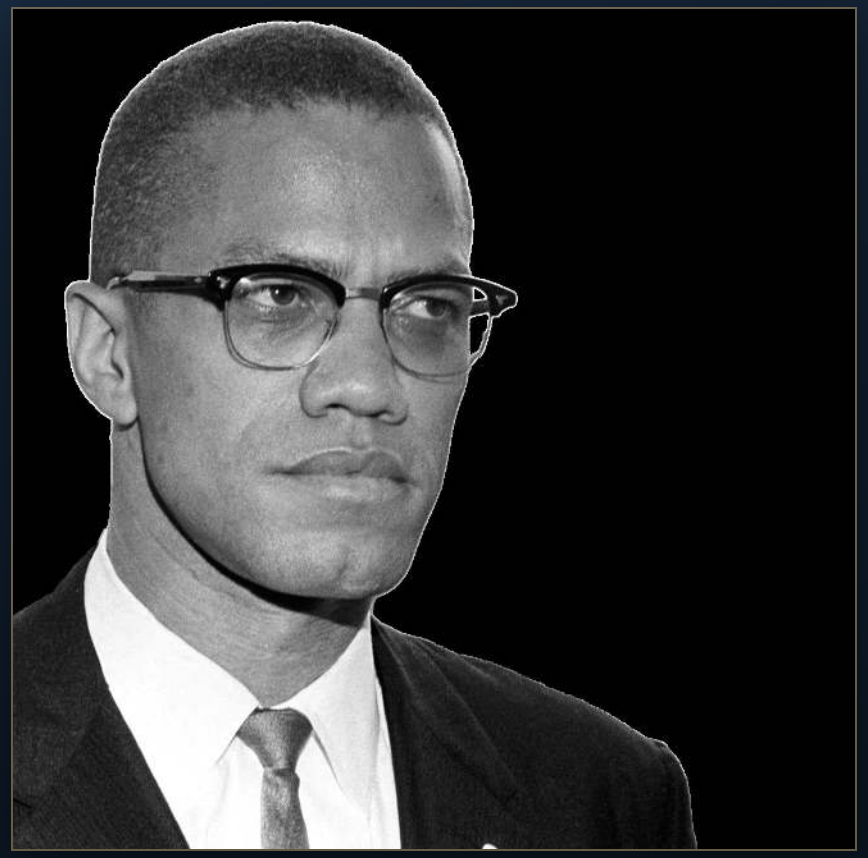
The Northern Struggle



- In the North, **de facto segregation** trapped Black families in poor, segregated cities.
- Legal victories did little to change poverty, housing, and police treatment.
- Frustration erupted in **urban riots**—like **Watts** in 1965.

Malcolm X

- **Malcolm X** rose to prominence through the **Nation of Islam**.
- He preached **Black nationalism**, self-reliance, and **self-defense** 'by any means necessary.'
- His message challenged King's nonviolence—and inspired a new generation.



Black Power



- By 1966, younger activists embraced '**Black Power**.'
- **Stokely Carmichael** and **SNCC** called for Black pride, unity, and self-determination.
- They rejected integration as the movement's only goal.

The Black Panthers

- The **Black Panther Party** (1966) armed itself to police the police.
- It also ran free breakfast programs, clinics, and schools.
- The Panthers embodied a bold, confrontational new spirit.



SECTION

1968: A Year of Loss

The Assassination of Dr. King



"All the News That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times

LATE CITY EDITION

Weather: Clearing today, turning cold tonight. Fair, cool tomorrow. Temp. range: today 62-44; Thurs. 75-52. Full U.S. report on Page 82.

VOL. CXVII . No. 40,849 NEW YORK, FRIDAY, APRIL 5, 1968 10 CENTS

MARTIN LUTHER KING IS SLAIN IN MEMPHIS; A WHITE IS SUSPECTED; JOHNSON URGES CALM

JOHNSON DELAYS TRIP TO HAWAII; MAY LEAVE TODAY

President Spends a Hectic Day Here and in Capital —Sees Thant at the U.N.

By MAX FRANKEL

WASHINGTON, April 4 — President Johnson postponed his trip to Hawaii at least until tomorrow after he heard of the death of the Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. tonight.

The news, which visibly shocked the President, came at the end of one of the most extraordinary days in perhaps the most extraordinary year of his Administration.

Mr. Johnson was to have flown from Washington at about midnight for a weekend of strategy conferences with his military and diplomatic leaders stationed in South Vietnam. On the way, he had planned a breakfast meeting in California with former President Dwight D. Eisenhower.

Instead, the President telephoned Mrs. King in Atlanta, made a brief appeal for calm on television and went to his office to follow the reports of unrest and disturbance given him periodically by Attorney General Ramsey Clark.

Cancels Dinner Appearance

Mr. Johnson also canceled an appearance before a Democratic party fund-raising dinner here —the final event of a hectic schedule that became ever more hectic as the day unfolded.

The President began the day by making final arrangements for the Hawaii meeting. It had been tentatively planned before his order Sunday to curtail the bombing of North Vietnam and was interested in establishing direct contact.

Hanoi Charges U.S. Raid Far North of 20th Parallel

By EVERT CLARK

WASHINGTON, April 4 — North Vietnam charged in a broadcast today that United States planes had bombed a "populated area" in northwestern Vietnam far north of the 20th parallel. The Defense Department said it knew of no such raid but was investigating.

President Johnson has ordered that there be no attacks on North Vietnam north of the 20th Parallel as a step toward de-escalating the war.

In South Vietnam, United States marines beat off an attack by about 400 North Vietnamese soldiers charging up a hill near Khesanh, killing 93. The Associated Press reported. Meanwhile, an American relief column was nearing the besieged base. Page 15.]

The Hanoi radio, in a broadcast monitored and translated here, said three waves of United States planes dropped more than 30 bombs on a "sepa-

Hanoi said that area near Laichau (cross) was target.

[rated sector" about 20 miles west of Laichau, capital of Lai chau Province, this morning.

The nearest village to that

Continued on Page 15, Column 1

HUMPHREY HINTS HE'LL ENTER RACE

Tells Unionists in Pittsburgh He Will Act Soon—Abel and Wirtz Back Him

By ROY REED

PITTSBURGH, April 4—Two thousand labor representatives, including the head of the United Steel Workers union, diplomatically urged Vice President Humphrey today to run for President.

The Vice President left little doubt that he would declare them, but he indicated that he would wait until President Johnson returned from his trip

Johnson Shuns Role Of '68 'Lame Duck,' Kennedy Was Told

By JOHN HERBERS

WASHINGTON, April 4—In his meeting with Senator Robert F. Kennedy yesterday President Johnson said he would remain out of the political fight this year because he did not believe it was appropriate for a "lame duck" President to try to pick his successor.

This and other details of the Johnson-Kennedy meeting were learned today from knowledgeable sources.

The meeting, which Senator Kennedy had requested in the interest of "national unity," was described as an extraordi-

DISMAY IN NATION

Negroes Urge Others to Carry on Spirit of Nonviolence

By LAWRENCE VAN GELDER

Dismay, shame, anger and foreboding marked the nation's reaction last night to the Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.'s murder.

From the high offices of state to the man in the street, news of the moderate civil rights leader's violent death in Memphis yesterday drew, for the most part, stunned and sober statements.

Most major Negro organizations and Negro leaders, lamenting Dr. King's death, expressed hope that it serve as a spur to others to carry on in his spirit of nonviolence. But some Negro militants responded with bitterness and anger.

Roy Wilkins, executive director of the National Association for the Advancement of Colored People, said his organization was "shocked and deeply grieved by the dastardly murder of Dr. Martin Luther King."

"His murderer or murderers must be promptly apprehended and brought to justice," Mr. Wilkins said.

'A Man of Peace'

"Dr. King was a symbol of the nonviolent civil rights protest movement. He was a man of peace, of dedication, of great courage. His senseless assassination solves nothing. It will not stay the civil rights movement; it will instead spur it to greater activity."

Whitney M. Young Jr., executive director of the National Urban League, said:

"We are unspeakably shocked by the murder of Martin Luther King, one of the greatest leaders of our time. This is a bitter reflection on America. We fear for our country.

PRESIDENT'S PLEA

On TV, He Deplores 'Brutal' Murder of Negro Leader

Statements by Johnson, and Humphrey are on Page 24.

WASHINGTON, April 4— President Johnson deplored tonight in a brief television address to the nation the "brutal slaying" of the Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.

He asked "every citizen to reject the blind violence that has struck Dr. King, who lived by nonviolence."

Mr. Johnson said he was postponing his scheduled departure tonight for a Honolulu conference on Vietnam and that instead he would leave tomorrow.

The President spoke from the White House. At the Washington Hilton Hotel, where Democratic members of Congress had gathered to honor the President and the Vice President, Mr. Humphrey, his voice strained with emotion, said:

"Martin Luther King stands with our other American martyrs in the cause of freedom and justice. His death is a terrible tragedy."

The dinner was canceled 15 to 15 minutes after the Vice President spoke. Mr. Johnson, who was scheduled to appear at the dinner, canceled his plans to attend.

F.B.I. Inquiry Ordered

Attorney General Ramsey Clark ordered an immediate inquiry by the Federal Bureau of Investigation into the shooting of Dr. King in Memphis.

He said the purpose of the investigation would be to determine whether any federal law had been violated.

One provision of the law that

THE REV. DR. MARTIN LUTHER KING Jr.

Scattered Violence Occurs In Harlem and Brooklyn

12 Are Arrested Here

By THOMAS A. JOHNSON

Sporadic violence erupted in Harlem and Brooklyn's Bedford-Stuyvesant section last night after news of Dr. Martin Luther King's assassination spread in the two predominantly Negro communities.

Mayor Lindsay, who went to Harlem in an effort to quell the outbreaks, was caught in the middle of an unruly crowd and had to be hustled into a limousine by bodyguards.

Widespread Disorders

Disorders broke out in scattered parts of the nation last night after the slaying of the Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. The National Guard was called out or alerted in several cities.

In Washington, scattered but persistent looting and vandalism erupted, led for a time by Stokely Carmichael, former head of the Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee. All available policemen were being

GUARD CALLED OUT

Curfew Is Ordered in Memphis, but Fires and Looting Erupt

By EARL CALDWELL

MEMPHIS, Friday, April 5— The Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., who preached nonviolence and racial brotherhood, was fatally shot here last night by a distant gunman who then raced away and escaped.

Four thousand National Guard troops were ordered into Memphis by Gov. Buford Ellington after the 39-year-old Nobel Prize-winning civil rights leader died.

A curfew was imposed on the shocked city of 530,000 inhabitants, 40 per cent of whom are Negro.

But the police said the tragedy had been followed by incidents that included sporadic shooting, fires, lootings and bottles thrown at policemen, and looting that started in Negro districts and then spread over the city.

White Car Sought

Police Director Frank Holloman said the assassin might have been a white man who was "30 to 100 yards away in a floorhouse."

Chief of Detectives W. P. Huston said a late model white Mustang was believed to have been the killer's getaway car. Its occupant was described as a tarheaded white man in his 30s, wearing a black suit and black tie.

The detective chief said the police had chased two cars near the motel where Dr. King was shot and had halted one that had two out-of-town men as occupants. The men were questioned but seemed to have nothing to do with the killing, he said.

- In 1968, King broadened his fight to **economic justice** and the **Poor People's Campaign**.
- On April 4, 1968, he was **assassinated** in Memphis.
- His death sparked grief, riots, and a sense that an era had ended.

The Movement's Legacy

I

A Transformed Nation

It ended **legal** segregation and reshaped American democracy.

II

New Voices

Black Power reshaped Black identity, culture, and politics.

III

Unfinished Work

The struggle for **economic and racial justice** continued.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Black Power & a Movement Divided

1. In the North, **de facto segregation** and poverty fueled frustration and **urban riots** like **Watts**.
2. **Malcolm X**, **Black Power**, and the **Black Panthers** challenged King's nonviolence and integrationism.
3. The **assassination** **of Dr. King** in 1968 marked the end of an era—leaving a transformed but still-unequal nation.

DISCUSS & APPLY

Black Power & a Movement Divided

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain why the movement **fragmented** even as it won landmark legal victories.

COMPARISON

Compare the philosophies of **Dr. King** and **Malcolm X**.

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

How did the goals of the movement **change** from 1955 to 1968?

Up next — **Class 58: Vietnam & the 1960s** (JFK, the Cold War & a nation in turmoil)